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Wound dressing with selective and dynamic transparency

Abstract

A selectively transparent wound therapy dressing, system, and method of use are provided. The dressing may include conformable foam and drape layers, wherein the drape layer has a refractive index substantially within a range of a disclosing liquid. When the disclosing liquid is applied to the drape layer, the drape layer may switch from opaque to transparent. Subsequent evaporation of the disclosing liquid may return the drape layer to an opaque state. Some embodiments provide for paired use with a negative pressure source input device. The method of use provides selective visibility of a treatment site, and reduces the amount of time in which a patient views an acute or traumatic wound or injury.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a US national phase application under 35 USC § 371 of International Application No. PCT/US2020/012901 filed on Jan. 9, 2020, which claims the benefit of priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/795,714, entitled “WOUND DRESSING WITH SELECTIVE AND DYNAMIC TRANSPARENCY” filed on Jan. 23, 2019, which are both incorporated herein by reference in their entireties.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The invention set forth in the claims relates generally to tissue treatment and more particularly, but without limitation, to dressings for tissue treatment and methods for using the dressings for tissue treatment both with and without negative pressure.

BACKGROUND

(2) The present disclosure relates generally to tissue treatment systems and, more particularly, to a wound dressing with selective and dynamic transparency.

(3) Clinicians and patients often have different desires for visualization of wounds and treatment sites. Patients often do not wish to see a wound or the peri-wound, as it can be upsetting or cause anxiety. Clinicians and medical practitioners, on the other hand, often need to view a wound or treatment site to check the wound condition and look for signs of treatment progression and healing indicators (e.g., redness, inflammation, maceration, etc.).

(4) Most wound dressings are either partially or fully occlusive. This makes it difficult for clinicians to view the progress of treatment. However, with selectively or dynamically transparent dressings clinicians can more accurately manage wound care. For example, dynamic transparency

allows a clinician to gauge the amount of fluids or exudate in a region of the wound. Visualization of the periwound is also crucial in judging healing progression and possible infection. Moreover, a wound dressing and system with selective transparency—i.e., one that can be switched “on” and “off”—may also allow clinicians and medical practitioners to place, and later locate, bio-sensors and indicators under a drape.

(5) Thus, an improved dressing, system, and method that allows a medical practitioner or physician to view a wound or treatment site when desired and occlude the wound or treatment site at all other times is needed.

SUMMARY

(6) The present disclosure overcomes the drawbacks of previously-known systems by providing an improved dressing, system, and method for selective visualization of a wound or periwound. The wound therapy dressing may include a foam layer, and a drape layer having a material with a refractive index substantially within a range of 1.3 to 1.55. The wound therapy dressing may also have a foam layer that is substantially transparent. In one embodiment of the wound therapy dressing, the foam layer may be white. The wound therapy dressing may also include a drape layer having a fabric comprising fine fibered polymers. In some embodiments, the fine fibered polymers may be elastic materials, including polyvinylidene fluoride (PVF), polyvinylidene difluoride (PVDF), ethylene-vinyl acetate, thermoplastic polyurethane, thermoplastic elastomer, thermoplastic vulcanizate, polyether block amide, polyamides, polyethyleneimines, or polyester. In other embodiments, the drape layer may be made of porous or microporous particles, including minerals or polymers. In some embodiments, the minerals may be silica, silicates, fluorites, or fluorides. In other embodiments, the polymers of the microporous drape layer may be fluoropolymers, silicones, or acrylics.

(7) In accordance with yet another aspect of the present disclosure, a wound therapy system is provided. The system may include a conformable, transparent foam dressing layer, and a conformable drape layer configured to extend over and adhere the transparent foam dressing layer to a treatment site. In a first state the drape layer may be opaque, in a second state, the drape layer may become transparent when a disclosing liquid with a refractive index within a range of the refractive index of the drape layer is applied to the drape layer, the second state occurring at a point in time subsequent to the first state, and in a third state, the drape layer may become opaque again as the disclosing liquid evaporates, the third state occurring at a point in time subsequent to the second state.

(8) The wound therapy system further may include a negative pressure wound input device. In one embodiment, the wound therapy system may couple to a hole in the drape layer through which air may be withdrawn from the treatment site. The drape layer of the wound therapy system further may be a fabric comprising fine fibered polymers. The fine fibered polymers may be elastic materials, such as polyvinylidene fluoride (PVF), polyvinylidene difluoride (PVDF), ethylene-vinyl acetate, thermoplastic polyurethane, thermoplastic elastomer, thermoplastic vulcanizate, polyether block amide, polyamides, polyethyleneimines, or polyester. In some embodiments, the fine fibered polymers may be plasma or corona surface treated. Further, the fine fibered polymers may have diameters from about less than 1 micrometer to about 30 micrometers. The fine fibered polymers may be manufactured from dry laid, airlaid, or woven manufacturing methods.

(9) In certain embodiments, a patient facing side of the drape layer further may have an about 5 micrometer to about 20 micrometer breathable polyurethane coating to enhance water proofing. The drape layer may also have an adhesive coat that can bond to either the transparent foam dressing layer, or, alternatively, directly to periwound or wound treatment sites. In some embodiments, the adhesive is one of an acrylic, polyurethane, or a silicone gel. The drape layer may also be made of microporous or porous particles. In some embodiments, the porous particles may be minerals or polymers. Some exemplary minerals include, but are not limited to, silica, silicates, fluorites, or fluorides. Some exemplary polymers include, but are not limited to,

fluoropolymers, silicones or acrylics.

(10) In some embodiments, the disclosing liquid used to saturate the drape layer may have a refractive index between about 1.0 to about 2.0. In some embodiments, the disclosing liquid used to saturate the drape layer may have a refractive index between about 1.2 to about 1.75. In some embodiments, the disclosing liquid used to saturate the drape layer may have a refractive index between about 1.33 to about 1.55. Further, the disclosing liquid may be fluorinated ethylene propylene polymer (FEP). In other embodiments, the disclosing liquid may be water or ethanol or any combination of water and ethanol. The disclosing liquid further may be ethanol and benzyl alcohol.

(11) The drape layer may be polyvinylidene difluoride (PVDF) bonded to a drape cover with the PVDF fused to the drape through heat lamination.

(12) In certain embodiments, an island dressing may be used in lieu of a foam dressing. The drape layer may also be interposed between multiple wound dressing layers. In the first state, the drape layer also may appear frosted. In certain embodiments, the foam pore sizes are less than or equal to one hundred (100) micrometers. Moreover, the drape layer also may be a foam with pore sizes less than or equal to 100 micrometers. In other embodiments, the drape layer may include two layers of polymeric polarizing filter. The drape layer further may include a pH indicator. The pH indicator may be phenolphthalein. In certain of these embodiments, an acid disclosing agent may be wiped over the drape layer. The acid disclosing agent also may be carbonated water or ethanol in concentration with carbonated water.

(13) In accordance with yet another aspect of the present disclosure, a method for providing wound therapy is provided. The method may include: (i) applying to a treatment site a wound therapy system that includes a conformable, transparent foam dressing layer, and a conformable, selectively-transparent drape layer configured to extend over and adhere the transparent foam dressing layer to a treatment site; (ii) applying a disclosing liquid with a refractive index within a range of the refractive index of the drape layer to the drape layer, allowing the selectively-transparent drape layer to change from an opaque state to a transparent state; (iii) observing the treatment site while the drape layer remains in the transparent state; and (iv) allowing the disclosing liquid to evaporate, which allows the drape layer to return to an opaque state.

(14) Using the treatment method, a patient may only see the treatment site while being examined by a medical practitioner or physician. A medical practitioner also may monitor healing at the periwound of a treatment site using this method. In some embodiments, the system further may include a negative pressure wound input device. In certain of these embodiments, the negative pressure wound input device may couple to a hole in the drape layer through which air is withdrawn from the treatment site.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 illustrates an exploded view from a roughly forty-five degree angle of an embodiment of the wound therapy dressing.

(2) FIG. 2 depicts the wound therapy dressing wherein the foam layer comprises fine fibered polymers.

(3) FIGS. 3A and 3B depict two possible embodiments where the drape layer is made up of porous particles.

(4) FIGS. 4A through FIG. 4C demonstrate the transition from a first state where the drape layer is opaque to a second state, where the drape layer becomes transparent when a disclosing liquid is applied, to a third state, where the drape layer returns to opaque as the disclosing liquid evaporates.

(5) FIG. 5A shows a side view of the wound therapy system, including a negative pressure input

device, applied on a treatment site. FIG. 5B illustrates a top view of an embodiment of the wound therapy system that includes the negative pressure input device.

(6) FIG. 6 shows an embodiment of the wound therapy system where the selectively transparent drape layer is interposed within, around, on top of, or between multiple wound dressing layers.

(7) FIG. 7 illustrates an embodiment of the wound therapy system where the drape layer is made of at least two layers of polymeric polarizing filter.

(8) FIG. 8 depicts an embodiment of the wound therapy system where the drape layer further includes a pH indicator.

(9) FIG. 9A and FIG. 9B illustrate a method for wound therapy wherein the wound therapy system is applied to a treatment site and a disclosing liquid with a refractive index within a range of the refractive index of the drape layer is applied to change the drape from an opaque state to a transparent state.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) Wound Therapy Dressing:

(11) A wound therapy dressing is provided herein. In certain embodiments, the wound therapy dressing illustratively may include a foam layer, and a drape layer wherein the drape layer is made of a material having a refractive index substantially within a range of 1.3 to 1.55. As used herein, the terms “substantially,” “substantial,” and “about” are used to describe and account for small variations. When used in conjunction with a material or a standard, the terms can refer to instances in which the standard or material occurs precisely as well as instances in which the event or circumstance occurs to a close approximation. For example, the terms can refer to less than or equal to $\pm 10\%$, such as less than or equal to $\pm 5\%$, less than or equal to $\pm 4\%$, less than or equal to $\pm 3\%$, less than or equal to $\pm 2\%$, less than or equal to $\pm 1\%$, less than or equal to $\pm 0.5\%$, less than or equal to $\pm 0.1\%$, or less than or equal to $\pm 0.05\%$.

(12) Referring to FIG. 1, an exemplary wound therapy dressing **10** in accordance with the principles of the present disclosure is described. Wound therapy dressing **10** may include foam layer **100** and drape layer **102**, wherein drape layer **102** has a refractive index substantially within a range of 1.3 to 1.55. Foam layer **100** may be substantially transparent, or non-transparent. Foam layer **100** further may be white.

(13) As shown in FIG. 2, drape layer **102** may be made of fabric **104** comprising fine fibered polymers **106**. Fine fibered polymers **106** also may be elastic or any suitable Modulus to fit securely over a wound bed. In certain embodiments, the elastic materials may include, but are not limited to: polyvinylidene fluoride (PVF), polyvinylidene difluoride (PVDF), ethylene-vinyl acetate, thermoplastic polyurethane, thermoplastic elastomer, thermoplastic vulcanizate, polyether block amide, polyamides, polyethyleneimines, or polyester.

(14) Referring to FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B, wound therapy dressing **10** also may have drape layer **102** made of porous particles **110** or microporous particles **112**. In some embodiments, porous particles **110** or microporous particles **112** further may be minerals or polymers. Exemplary minerals include, but are not limited to, silica, silicates, fluorites, or fluorides. Exemplary polymers include, but are not limited to, fluoropolymers, silicones, or acrylics.

(15) Wound Therapy System:

(16) A wound therapy system is also provided herein. Referring to FIGS. 4A-4C and FIGS. 5A-5B, in one embodiment, wound therapy system **20** may include conformable foam dressing layer **200** and conformable drape layer **202**. Conformable drape layer **202** may be configured to extend over and adhere foam dressing layer **200** to treatment site **204** or wound bed, which further may include periwound **205**. The treatment site may be a wound bed. Referring to FIG. 4A, in first state **206** drape layer **202** is opaque. Referring to FIG. 4B, in second state **210**, drape layer **202** becomes transparent when disclosing liquid **210** with a refractive index within a range of the refractive index of drape layer **202** is applied to drape layer **202**. Second state **206** occurs at a point in time subsequent to first state **206**. Referring to FIG. 4C, in third state **212**, drape layer **202** becomes

opaque again as disclosing liquid **210** evaporates. Third state **212** occurs at a point in time subsequent to second state **210**. Wound therapy system **20** further may have negative pressure wound input device **214**, as shown from a side view in FIG. 5A. As further shown in FIG. 5B, negative pressure wound input device **214** may couple to hole **216** in drape layer **202** through which air may be withdrawn from treatment site **204**. Either or both conformable foam dressing layer **200** and conformable drape layer **202** may be transparent or selectively-transparent.

(17) Drape layer **202** may be made of fabric **104**, which further may comprise fine-fibered polymers. The fine-fibered polymers **106** of wound therapy system **20** may be elastic materials. In certain embodiments, exemplary elastic materials may include, but are not limited to: polyvinylidene fluoride (PVF), polyvinylidene difluoride (PVDF), ethylene-vinyl acetate, thermoplastic polyurethane, thermoplastic elastomer, thermoplastic vulcanizate, polyether block amide, polyamides, polyethyleneimines, or polyester. Fine-fibered polymers of wound therapy system **20** also may be plasma or corona surface treated. In some embodiments, fine-fibered polymers of wound therapy system **20** may have diameters from about less than 1 micrometer to about 30 micrometers. In some embodiments, the polymers may be manufactured from dry laid, airlaid, or woven manufacturing methods. In certain embodiments, a patient facing side of drape layer **202** further has an about 5 micrometer to an about 20 micrometer breathable polyurethane coating to enhance water proofing. Drape layer **202** also may include an adhesive coating that can bond to either foam dressing layer **200** or directly to periwound **205**. In some embodiments, the adhesive may be an acrylic, polyurethane, or a silicone gel. Drape layer **202** may also be made of porous or microporous particles. In certain embodiments, the porous particles may be minerals or polymers. Exemplary minerals may include, but are not limited to: silica, silicates, fluorites, or fluorides. Exemplary polymers may include, but are not limited to: fluoropolymers, silicones, or acrylics.

(18) Disclosing liquid **210** may have a range of refractive indexes, including, but not limited to, a range between about 1.0 and about 2.0, between about 1.2 and about 1.75, or between about 1.33 and 1.35. If the refractive index of disclosing liquid **210** and drape **202** are close, as air is displaced more transparency may be achieved in drape **202**. Disclosing liquid **210** further may be fluorinated ethylene propylene polymer (FEP). In some embodiments, disclosing liquid **210** is water or any combination of water and ethanol. Disclosing liquid **210** also may be ethanol or benzyl alcohol. In one particular embodiment, drape layer **202** is polyvinylidene difluoride (PVDF) bonded to a drape cover and the PVDF is fused to the drape cover through heat lamination. An island dressing also may be used in lieu of or in combination with a foam dressing.

(19) Referring now to FIG. 6, drape layer **202** is shown disposed above or on top of a plurality of wound dressing layers **218**. In other embodiments, drape layer **202** may be interposed within, around, or between more than one other wound dressing layer. In some embodiments, drape layer **202** may appear frosted or partially frosted in first state **206**. The pore sizes of foam dressing layer **200** may be less than or equal to 100 micrometers. Additionally, draper layer **202** also may be a foam composite and can also have pore sizes less than or equal to 100 micrometers.

(20) Referring now to FIG. 7, drape layer **202** also may include two or more layers of polymeric polarizing filter **220**. As further shown in FIG. 8, drape layer **202** also may include pH indicator **222**. A cationic polymer, such as polyethyleneimine may be mixed with a cover film, or coated on with a pH indicator, such as phenolphthalein which can provide a deep pink hiding color to block visibility of wound treatment site **204** or periwound **205**. If an acid is used as disclosing liquid **210** and wiped over drape **202**, pH indicator **222** may become clear. One suitable volatile acid may be carbonated water. Ethanol may be added to the carbonated water to increase its volatility.

(21) Method of Use:

(22) A method for wound therapy is also provided herein. Referring to FIG. 9A and FIG. 9B, the method may include: i) applying to treatment site **204** conformable foam dressing **200** and conformable drape layer **202** by extending drape layer **202** over and adhering drape layer **202** to

foam dressing layer **200** ii) applying disclosing liquid **210** with a refractive index within a range of the refractive index of drape layer **202**, wherein the selectively-transparent drape layer **202** changes from a first opaque state **206** to a second transparent state **208**, iii) observing treatment site **204** while drape layer **202** remains in second transparent state **208**, and iv) allowing disclosing liquid **210** to evaporate, whereby drape layer **202** enters a third, opaque state **212**.

(23) Following the disclosed method, in one use of the method, a patient could limit visibility of the treatment site to moments when they are being examined by a medical practitioner. A medical practitioner or clinician may use this method to monitor healing at periwound **205** or on a wound bed or treatment site **204**, and then return drape layer **202** to opaque state **212** after an appointment or office visit is complete. This method is partially designed to alleviate patient stress and anxiety associated with viewing severe wound beds when recovering from a traumatic or acute injury.

(24) The method further may include negative pressure wound input device **214** coupled to system **20**. Negative pressure wound input device **214** may couple to hole **216** in drape layer **202**, through which air may be withdrawn from treatment site **204**.

(25) While various illustrative embodiments of the invention are described above, it will be apparent to one skilled in the art that various changes and modifications may be made herein without departing from the invention. The appended claims are intended to cover all such changes and modifications that fall within the scope of the invention.

Claims

1. A wound therapy system comprising: a conformable foam dressing layer; and a conformable drape layer configured to extend over and adhere the conformable foam dressing layer to a treatment site, the conformable drape layer comprising at least two layers of polymeric polarizing filter; wherein in a first state, the conformable drape layer is opaque; wherein in a second state, the conformable drape layer becomes transparent when a disclosing liquid with a refractive index within a range of the refractive index of the conformable drape layer is applied to the conformable drape layer; and wherein in a third state, the conformable drape layer becomes opaque as the disclosing liquid evaporates.
2. The wound therapy system of claim 1, wherein the conformable drape layer comprises a fabric comprising fine fibered polymers.
3. The wound therapy system of claim 2, wherein the fine fibered polymers comprise elastic materials.
4. The wound therapy system of claim 3, wherein the elastic materials comprise polyvinylidene fluoride (PVF), polyvinylidene difluoride (PVDF), ethylene-vinyl acetate, thermoplastic polyurethane, thermoplastic elastomer, thermoplastic vulcanizate, polyether block amide, polyamides, polyethyleneimines, or polyester.
5. The wound therapy system of claim 2, wherein the fine fibered polymers are plasma or corona surface treated.
6. The wound therapy system of claim 2, wherein the fine fibered polymers comprise diameters from about less than 1 micrometer to about 30 micrometers, and wherein the polymers are manufactured from dry laid, airlaid, or woven manufacturing methods.
7. The wound therapy system of claim 1, wherein a patient facing side of the conformable drape layer further comprises an about 5 micrometer to about 20 micrometer breathable polyurethane coating to enhance water proofing.
8. The wound therapy system of claim 1, wherein the conformable drape layer comprises porous or microporous particles, and the porous or microporous particles comprise minerals or polymers, and wherein the minerals comprise silica, silicates, fluorites, or fluorides, and the polymers comprise fluoropolymers, silicones, or acrylics.
9. The wound therapy system of claim 1, wherein the disclosing liquid comprises a refractive index

range between about 1.0 and about 2.0.

10. The wound therapy system of claim 1, wherein the disclosing liquid comprises a refractive index range between about 1.2 and about 1.75.

11. The wound therapy system of claim 1, wherein the disclosing liquid comprises a refractive index range between about 1.33. and 1.55.

12. The wound therapy system of claim 1, wherein the disclosing liquid comprises fluorinated ethylene propylene polymer (FEP).

13. The wound therapy system of claim 1, wherein the disclosing liquid comprises water or ethanol or any combination of water and ethanol, or comprises ethanol and benzyl alcohol.

14. The wound therapy system of claim 1, wherein the conformable drape layer comprises polyvinylidene difluoride (PVDF) bonded to a drape cover and the PVDF is fused to the drape cover through heat lamination.

15. The wound therapy system of claim 1, wherein foam pore sizes are less than or equal to 100 micrometers, wherein the conformable drape layer is also a foam and also comprises foam pore sizes less than or equal to 100 micrometers.

16. The wound therapy system of claim 1, wherein the conformable drape layer further comprises a pH indicator, and wherein the pH indicator comprises phenolphthalein.

17. The wound therapy system of claim 16, wherein an acid disclosing agent is wiped over the conformable drape layer, and wherein the acid disclosing agent comprises carbonated water or ethanol in concentration with carbonated water.
